Project Design Phase

Problem – Solution Fit Template

Date	29 October 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	FreelanceHub — MERN Stack Freelancing Platform
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

1. CUSTOMER SEGMENT(S)

Early-career freelancers, such as recent graduates, who want to find real project work and build a reputation, and small business owners or project owners who need creative or technical work done and want to hire reliably — without juggling emails, chats and spreadsheets to manage the process.

2. JOBS-TO-BE-DONE / PROBLEMS

Freelancers need to register and log in securely, browse and filter open projects by skill, apply with a proposal, rate and portfolio link, track the status of every application, and talk to the client once selected. Clients need to post projects with a title, description, budget, duration and required skills, review all applications in one place, approve or reject each one, and collaborate with the chosen freelancer.

3. TRIGGERS

A client with a project to finish who is receiving proposals, rates and portfolio links through scattered emails and messages and cannot compare them easily; a freelancer who applied for a project and has no idea whether the application was seen, accepted or rejected.

4. EMOTIONS: BEFORE / AFTER

Before: uncertain whether an application was ever seen, or overwhelmed by proposals arriving from many directions, and unsure whether the right person is being chosen. After: confident, with a clear Pending, Approved or Rejected status on every application and a real-time chat that opens as soon as a client approves a freelancer.

5. AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS

Large general-purpose freelance marketplaces that can feel crowded and complex for beginners and small clients; informal hiring through social media, messaging apps and email, where proposals and decisions are hard to track; or custom-built hiring tools that need significant engineering time to get right.

6. CUSTOMER CONSTRAINTS

Running the application requires Node.js (v16 or above), npm, and a MongoDB connection (local or a free MongoDB Atlas cluster). End users working on the platform need nothing beyond a modern web browser.

7. BEHAVIOUR

Users register with a role (Client or Freelancer) and log in. Clients post and manage projects and review applications; freelancers browse and filter projects and apply. The React client uses an Axios-based API

layer to talk to the backend, with a JWT attached automatically to every request, and keeps a Socket.io connection open for real-time chat.

8. CHANNELS OF BEHAVIOUR

8.1 ONLINE: The FreelanceHub web application itself, reached directly or through links shared on social and professional platforms.

8.2 OFFLINE: Word-of-mouth recommendations between freelancers, students and local business owners; potential future college or community notice boards and QR codes directing people to the platform.

9. PROBLEM ROOT CAUSE

Hiring and applying for small projects usually happens across scattered channels, with no single place that connects a posted project, the applications it receives, the client's decision and the conversation that follows — which leaves freelancers without status updates and clients without an easy way to compare and decide.

10. YOUR SOLUTION

FreelanceHub brings the whole flow into a single MERN application: projects, applications, approval status and chat all live in the same data model and codebase. Role-based JWT authentication keeps each user to the actions their role allows, and approving an application is what unlocks the real-time chat — so the hiring decision and the collaboration are directly connected.